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India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

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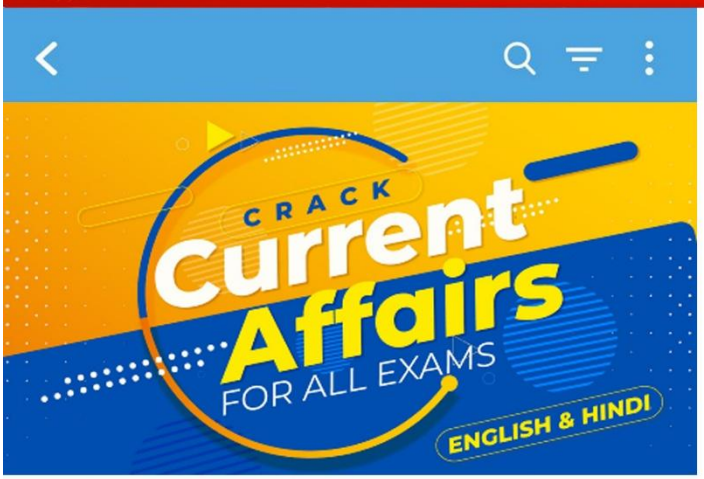
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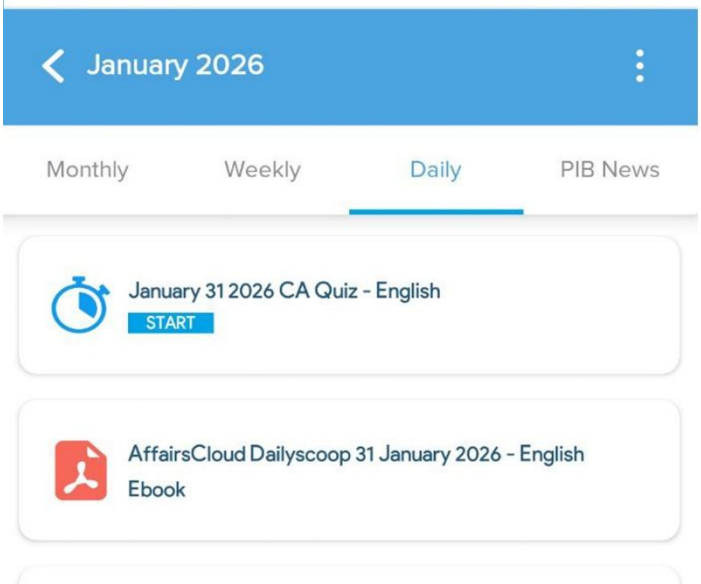
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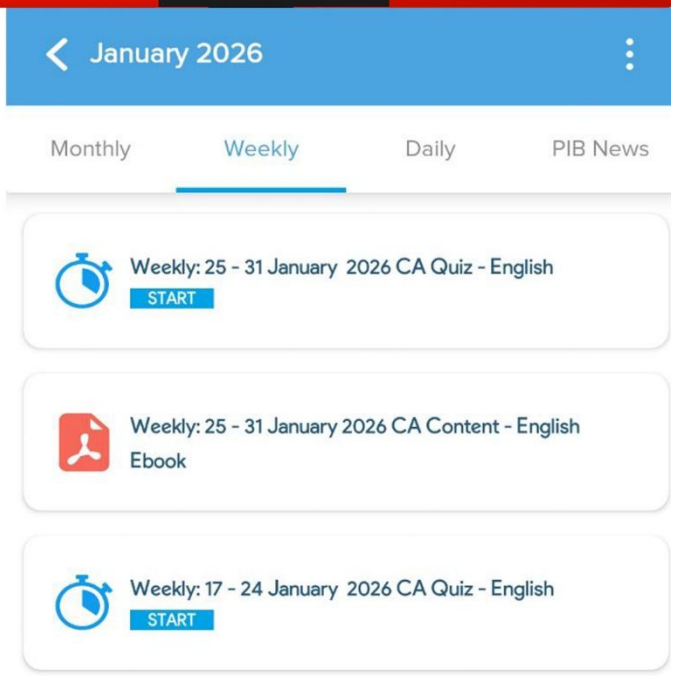
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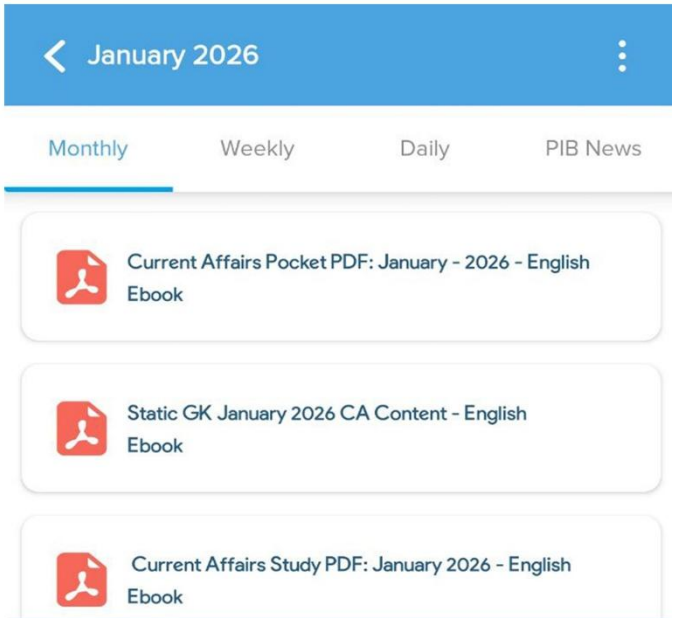
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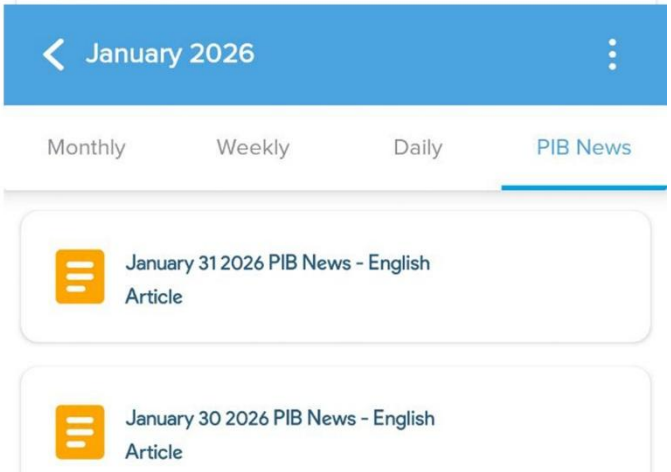
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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

PM Narendra Modi —Visited→ Gujarat —On→ 30-31 October 2026 —Launched→ Projects Worth Over Rs 14,400 Crore —In→ Banaskantha & Ekta Nagar

Banaskantha Projects – Around Rs 14,000 Crore

- BBRC Facility: Rs 325 Crore, Bhildi
- ET-IVF Laboratory: Target of 25,000 embryos annually
- ASRS Facility: Rs 31.14 Crore, Palanpur
- French Fries Plant: Rs 51.65 Crore, Sanadar
- Bio-CNG Plants: Tharad & Radhanpur
- Ahmedabad Metro: Phase-2A & Phase-2B
- SH-41 Widening: Rs 2,600 Crore, 4 to 8 lanes
- Anganwadi Centres: 4,030 new & 361 inaugurated
- Agriculture Infrastructure Fund: 521 projects worth Rs 4,950 Crore

Ekta Nagar Development Projects

- Total Projects: 31 worth Rs 426.71 Crore
- Inaugurated: 23 projects worth Rs 307.83 Crore
- Foundation Stones: 8 projects worth Rs 118.88 Crore
- IRCTC Hotel: Rs 50 Crore
- Ekta Cruise: Rs 16 Crore
- Rainforest Attraction: Rs 14.30 Crore
- Eco-Trail: Rs 3.67 Crore

PM-KISAN 24th Instalment

- Released Amount: Over Rs 18,690 Crore
- Beneficiaries: 9.34 Crore Farmers
- Cumulative Disbursement: Over Rs 4.64 Lakh Crore

Rashtriya Ekta Diwas

- Observed: 31 October 2026
- Commemoration: Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 151st Birth Anniversary

PM – Prime Minister
BBRC – Bharat Bovine Breeding and Research Centre
ET-IVF – Embryo Transfer Technology–In Vitro Fertilisation
ASRS – Automated Storage and Retrieval System
Bio-CNG – Bio-Compressed Natural Gas
SH – State Highway
PM-KISAN –Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi
IRCTC – Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation

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2)

Narendra Modi (Prime Minister) —Approved→ Delhi-Guwahati Bullet Train Corridor via Siliguri (1500 Km)

- Route: Delhi-Guwahati via Siliguri; travel time cut from 20 to 6 hours.
- Coverage: Delhi, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, West Bengal and Assam.
- Budget: Part of 7 high-speed rail corridors announced in Union Budget 2026-27.

3)

India —Hosts→ 1st-Ever BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise —In→ Andaman and Nicobar Islands, 30 October–3 November 2026

Members: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand.

- **Theme:** "Shared Seas, Shared Security and Shared Prosperity."
- **Tagline:** "Translating Vision to Action."
- **Phases:**
  - 3-day Tabletop Phase.
  - 2-day Harbour Phase.

Abbreviation

BIMSTEC – Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation.

4)

Mansukh Mandaviya (MoL&E) —Inaugurated→ 74th Foundation Day of EPFO —In→ New Delhi, Delhi

- Launches: WhatsApp services and automatic settlement of inoperative EPF accounts (up to Rs. 1,000).
- WhatsApp: PF balance, last 5 transactions, passbook and PMVBRY assistance.
- Publications: 7 releases covering EPFO performance, legal updates, governance
- Awards: Bhavishya Nidhi Awards 2026 for offices and employees.
- Settlement: Nearly 1 lakh accounts worth Rs. 5 crore.

EPFO – Employees' Provident Fund Organisation

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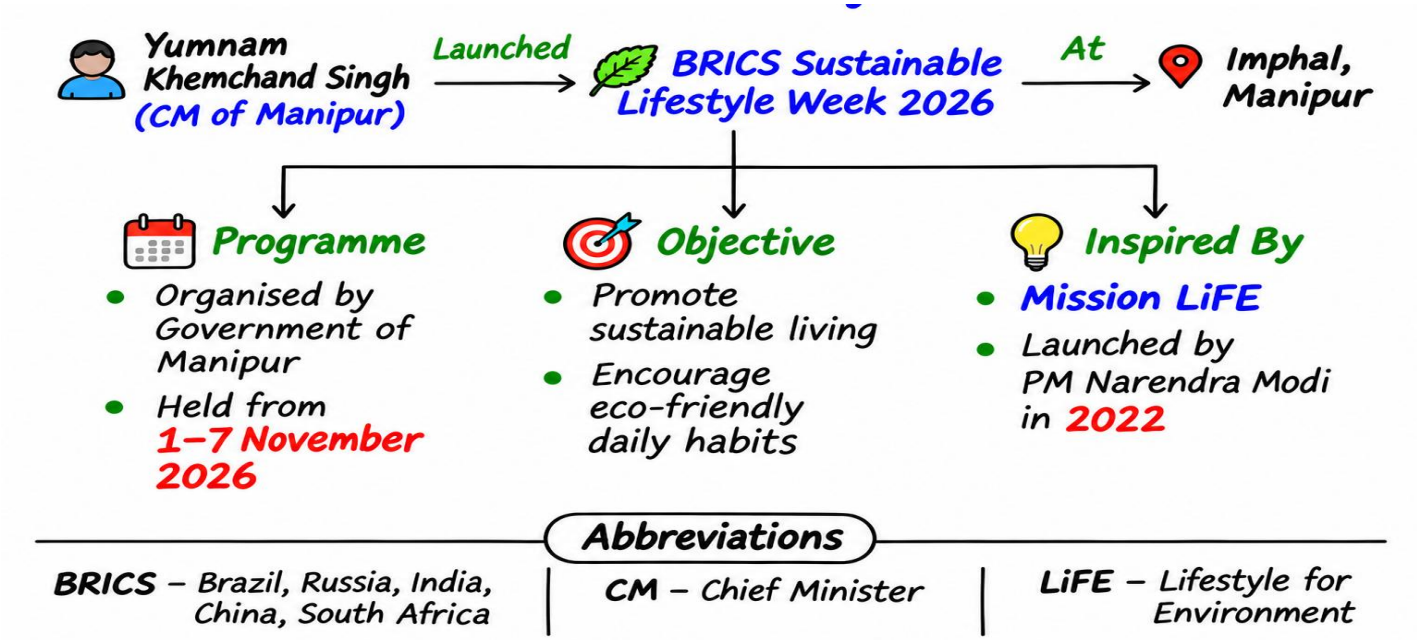
EPF – Employees' Provident Fund

PF – Provident Fund

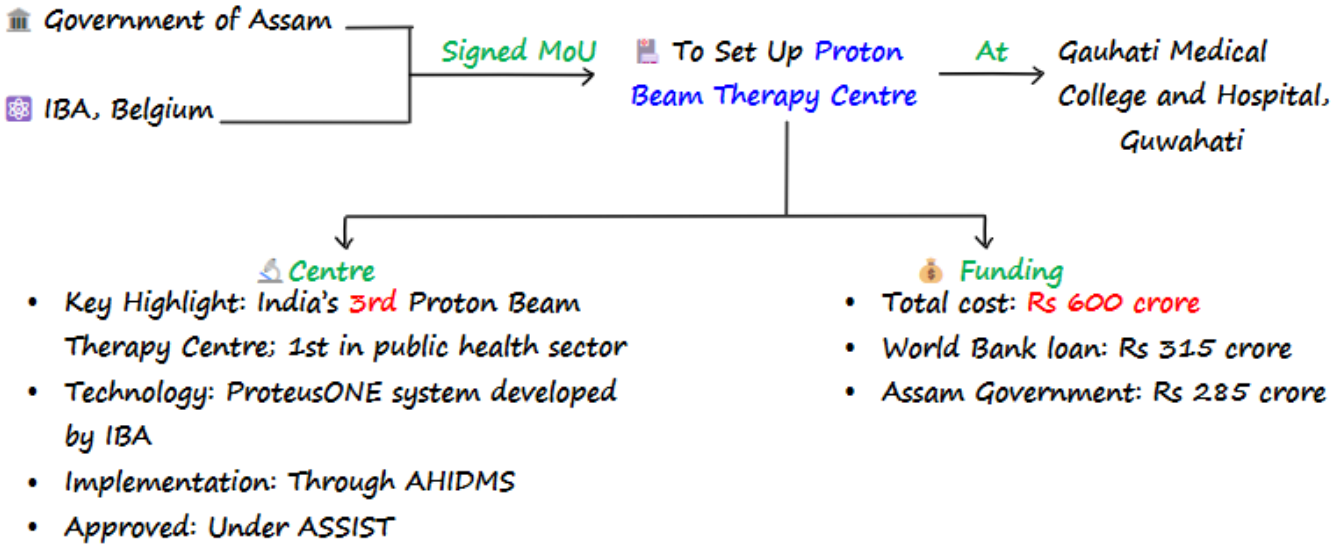
PMVBRY – Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana

MoL&E – Ministry of Labour and Employment

5)



6)



MoU – Memorandum of Understanding

IBA – Ion Beam Applications

ASSIST – Assam State Secondary Healthcare Initiative for Service Delivery Transformation

AHIDMS – Assam Health Infrastructure Development & Management Society

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BANKING & FINANCE

1)

SEBI —Released→ Rationalisation of periodicity of KYC review for FPIs —Extended→ Review Periodicity to 8 Years —For→ Eligible Foreign Portfolio Investors

(Effective 1 December 2026)

- Review Cycle: Extended from 3 to 8 years; specified annual reviews from 1 to 2 years.
- Category I: High-risk – 8 years (Regulation 5(a)(i)) and 2 years (others); non-high-risk – 8 years.
- Category II: High-risk – 2 years; non-high-risk regulated – 8 years; others – 2 years.
- Compliance: Change-intimation and no-change declaration requirements removed.
- Continuance Fee: Pay 15 days before registration expiry.
- GS-FPIs: KYC linked to bank account review under RBI guidelines.
- SWAGAT-FI: Existing 10-year KYC cycle retained.
- Fee: Pay applicable charges to DDPs for 3-year or 10-year continuation.

SEBI – Securities and Exchange Board of India

FPI – Foreign Portfolio Investor

KYC – Know Your Customer

RBI – Reserve Bank of India

GS-FPI – Government Securities Foreign Portfolio Investor

SWAGAT-FI – Single Window Automatic and Generalised Access for Trusted Foreign Investors

DDP – Designated Depository Participant

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

1)

Union Minister Amit Shah (MHA)

- Presented: President's Colour —To→ Chandigarh Police —On→ 60th Raising Day & Diamond Jubilee of Police Lines, Sector 26, Chandigarh
- Flagged off : Run for Unity —To Mark→ Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's 151st Birth Anniversary —Sets→ Drug-Free India Target: 31 December 2029

MHA – Ministry of Home Affairs

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APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

1)

Iliana Iotova (Former VP) — Became → Bulgaria's 1st Elected Female President

Succeeded → Andrey Gyurov

Votes: Iliana Iotova – 57.58% (approx. 11 lakh); Andrey Gyurov – 39.47%

Vice President (VP): Served from 2017–2026.

2)

Dinesh Vitthalrao Ganvir (Geologist) → Assumed Charge → As 55th Director General (DG) of the Geological Survey of India (GSI),

Succeeded → Varsha Ashok Agalwe (54th and first woman DG)

3)

Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal → Took charge → As Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief (AOC-in-C) → Of Eastern Air Command (EAC), Indian Air Force (IAF)

Succeeded → Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia

Awards: Received the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal (AVSM) and Vayu Sena Medal (VM).

SPORTS

1)

India → Won → Both men's and women's titles → At → Inaugural Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026

Ahmedabad, Gujarat (7 – 11 October 2026)

Organiser: Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India (AKFI) with approval from the International Kabaddi Federation (IKF).

Winners:

Event	Gold	Silver	Bronze
Men's	India	Sri Lanka	Kenya & Bangladesh
Women's	India	Uganda	Kenya & Sri Lanka

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2)

Senior World Wrestling Championships 2026 —Held→ Astana, Kazakhstan —On→ 24 October to 1 November 2026

Organiser: United World Wrestling (UWW)

Medal Tally

Rank	Nation	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	USA	7	2	6	15
2	Iran	6	4	5	15
3	Russia	4	3	7	14
4	Japan	3	3	4	10
5	China	3	0	3	6
6	India	1	2	1	4

India Medals:

Athlete	Event	Category	Medal
Manisha Bhanwala	Women's Freestyle	59kg	Gold
Neelam Sirohi	Women's Freestyle	50kg	Silver
Kajal Dhochak	Women's Freestyle	76kg	Silver
Tanu Sharma	Women's Freestyle	72kg	Bronze

📊 Team Rankings: USA topped men's freestyle (194 points) and women's freestyle (137 points); Iran led men's Greco-Roman (192 points).

USA - United States of America

3)

Nominated → MYAS | For → Rahul Dravid & Saina Nehwal | Host City → 2030 CWG Organising Committee → Ahmedabad, Gujarat

Nomination Details

- Private-Sector Nominees: Jinal Mehta & Ananya Birla
- Committee Strength: 12–15 Members

Abbreviations

MYAS — Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports
CWG — Commonwealth Games

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OBITUARY

1)

Ved Rahi → Veteran Dogri Writer and Filmmaker

- Born J&K
- Passed away at 93 Maharashtra
- Awards: Sahitya Akademi Award (1983) for Dogri collection Aale; Sahitya Akademi Fellowship (2024).
- Career: Wrote scripts and dialogues for around 25 Hindi films; directed Doordarshan (DD) serials.

IMPORTANT DAYS

1)

2 November 2026 → International Day to End Impunity for Crimes against Journalists

UN's 13th observance

- 2026 Theme: "Threats Evolve. Impunity Endures"
- First Observance: 2 November 2014
- UNESCO's 2026 report:
  - Killings: 189 journalists (2024–2025).
  - Conflict: 67% killed in conflict zones.
  - Drones: 50 deaths across six war zones.
  - Impunity: 86%
- 2026 Event: Commemorated at UNESCO Headquarters, Paris, France, with a policy dialogue and townhall on journalist safety

UN – United Nations

UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

STATE NEWS

1)

Digital Bharat Nidhi (DBN) → Signed → Utilisation Agreement → With → Tamil Nadu Government & TANFINET

Utilisation Agreement → Under → Amended BharatNet Programme (ABP)

Objective: Expand rural broadband for e-Governance, digital payments, online education and telemedicine.

Connectivity: Targeted 5 lakh+ rural household fibre connections and broadband access to 4,767 villages on demand.

TANFINET – Tamil Nadu FibreNet Corporation

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Detailed Content

Current Affairs 3 November 2026: Headlines



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- PM Narendra Modi Approves Delhi–Guwahati Bullet Train Corridor via Siliguri
- India Hosts First-Ever BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise in Andaman and Nicobar Islands
- Union Minister Dr Mansukh Mandaviya Inaugurates 74th Foundation Day of EPFO in New Delhi
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- SEBI Extends KYC Review Periodicity to 8 Years for Eligible Foreign Portfolio Investors
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- Former VP Iliana Iotova Became Bulgaria's 1st Elected Female President
- Dinesh Vitthalrao Ganvir Assumes Charge as 55th DG of GSI
- Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal Takes Over as AOC-in-C of IAF's Eastern Air Command
- India Wins Both Men's and Women's Titles at Inaugural Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026 in Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- Senior World Wrestling Championships 2026: USA Tops; India Won 4 Medals; Manisha Bhanwala Won India's First Gold in Women's Freestyle
- Rahul Dravid and Saina Nehwal Nominated to 2030 Commonwealth Games Organising Committee
- Veteran Dogri Writer and Filmmaker Ved Rahi Passes Away at 93
- International Day to End Impunity for Crimes against Journalists 2026 – November 2
- Digital Bharat Nidhi Signs Agreement with TN to Expand BharatNet Connectivity under ABP

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NATIONAL AFFAIRS

Overview of PM Narendra Modi Visit to Gujarat from October 30 to 31, 2026

Prime Minister (**PM**) **Narendra Modi** visited **Gujarat** from **30 to 31 October 2026,** during which he inaugurated and laid the foundation stones for several infrastructure, agriculture, dairy and social welfare projects worth over **Rs 14,400 crore** across Banaskantha and Ekta Nagar in Narmada district, Gujarat.

- He also participated in the Rashtriya Ekta Diwas (National Unity Day) celebrations at Ekta Nagar on 31 October 2026, commemorating the 151st birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Overview of PM Modi visit to Gujarat
- ✓ **Dates of Visit:** October 30 to October 31, 2026
- ✓ **Total Cost of Projects:** More than 14,400 crore, including Rs 14,000 crore in Banaskantha and Rs 400 crore in Ekta Nagar
- ✓ **Visit to Banaskantha:**
- ✓ **Projects Inaugurated:** BBBRC facility (Rs Rs 325 crore); ASRS Facility (Rs 31.14 crore); The French fries processing plant (Rs 51.65 crore)
- ✓ **Other Key Highlight:** Release of the 24th instalment of PM-KISAN (over Rs 18,690 crore), benefitting 9.34 crore eligible farmers
- ✓ **Visit to Ekta Nagar:**
- ✓ **Key Highlight:** Inauguration and laying of foundation stone of development projects
- ✓ **Total Cost:** Rs 426.71 crore
- ✓ **Total Development Projects:** 31, 23 development projects (worth Rs 307.83 crore); and 8 development projects (worth Rs 118.88 crore)

Visit to Banaskantha:

Inauguration of BBBRC: PM Modi inaugurated the Rs 325 crore Bharat Bovine Breeding and Research Centre (BBRC) and its Embryo Transfer Technology–In Vitro Fertilisation (ET-IVF) laboratory at Bhildi, developed by Banas Dairy with technical support from the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB). Spread across 127 acres, it targets 25,000 high-quality embryos annually to improve indigenous cattle and buffalo breeds.

Other Key Banas Dairy Projects: He inaugurated the Rs 31.14 crore Automated Storage and Retrieval System (ASRS) at Palanpur, with a capacity of 11,000 pallets, and the Rs 51.65 crore French fries processing plant at Sanadar, designed to increase production from 2 to 5 tonnes per hour.



Bio-CNG Plants: He laid the foundation stones for two Bio-Compressed Natural Gas (Bio-CNG) plants at Tharad and Radhanpur, with cattle dung processing capacities of 75 and 100 Metric Tonnes (MT) per day, respectively.

Metro and Road Projects: He laid the foundation stones for Ahmedabad Metro Phase-2A (over 6 kilometres (km), 5 stations) and Phase-2B (3.3 km, 3 stations) and announced the Rs 2,600 crore widening of Ahmedabad– Mehsana State Highway (SH-41) from four to eight lanes.

Railway Connectivity: He flagged off the Ahmedabad (Sabarmati)–Varanasi Express and Mehsana–Becharaji–Sabarmati Mainline Electric Multiple Unit (MEMU) train services.

Anganwadi Centres: He laid the foundation stone for 4,030 child-friendly Anganwadi Centres and inaugurated 361 completed centres, involving an investment of Rs 800 crore.

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Agriculture Infrastructure: He dedicated 521 projects worth Rs 4,950 crore under the Agriculture Infrastructure Fund (AIF), including cold storage facilities, warehouses, silos and food-processing infrastructure.

PM-KISAN Instalment: He released the 24th instalment of Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi (PM-KISAN), disbursing over Rs 18,690 crore to 9.34 crore farmers. The cumulative disbursement under the scheme crossed Rs 4.64 lakh crore.

Visit to Ekta Nagar:

Development Projects: PM Modi inaugurated 23 projects worth Rs 307.83 crore and laid the foundation stones for 8 projects worth Rs 118.88 crore, totalling 31 projects worth Rs 426.71 crore.

Tourism Projects: Major inaugurated facilities included an Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC) hotel (Rs 50 crore), Ekta Cruise (Rs 16 crore), rainforest attraction (Rs 14.30 crore) and eco-trail (Rs 3.67 crore).

Bharat Parv 2026: He inaugurated Bharat Parv at Ekta Nagar on 30 October 2026, with celebrations scheduled until 15 November 2026.

Other Projects: Foundation stones were laid for Gora–Bhandra Road Development, a zero-waste smart solid waste management project, Khalwani Eco Tourism Development and improvements to the Cactus and Butterfly Garden.

About Gujarat:

Chief Minister **(CM)-** Bhupendrabhai Patel
Governor- Acharya Devvrat
Capital- Gandhinagar
National Parks (**NP**)- Gir NP, Marine NP

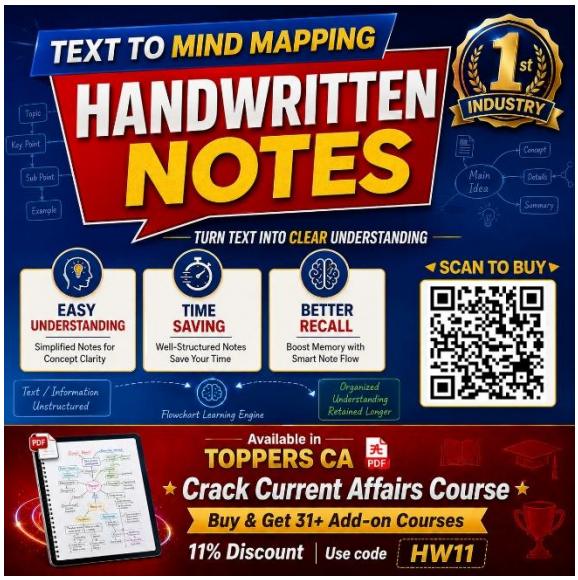
PM Narendra Modi Approves Delhi–Guwahati Bullet Train Corridor via Siliguri

On 31 October 2026, Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi **approved** the **1,500 kilometers (km) Northern Bullet Train Corridor,** connecting **Delhi** with **Guwahati** (Assam) via Siliguri (West Bengal, WB), enhancing regional connectivity, reducing travel time and boosting economic growth across **northern, eastern** and **northeastern India**.

- The approval was announced by **Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw,** Ministry of Railways **(MoR)**, in Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh (UP), during the flag-off ceremony of the Varanasi–New Delhi Vande Bharat Sleeper Express.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Northern Bullet Train Corridor
- ✓ **Route:** Delhi to Guwahati (Assam) via Siliguri (West Bengal)
- ✓ **Approved By:** Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi
- ✓ **Announced By:** Union Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw, MoR
- ✓ **Length:** Approximately 1,500 km
- ✓ **States/UTs Covered:** NCT of Delhi, UP, Bihar, WB and Assam
- ✓ **Union Budget 2026–27**: 7 new high-speed rail corridors announced.



About Northern Bullet Train Corridor

Background: In the Union Budget 2026–27, Union Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, Ministry of Finance (MoF), announced 7 new high-speed rail corridors: Mumbai–Pune,

Pune–Hyderabad, Hyderabad–Bengaluru, Hyderabad–Chennai, Chennai–Bengaluru, Delhi–Varanasi and Varanasi–Siliguri.

- Meanwhile, India's first bullet train project, the 508 km Mumbai–Ahmedabad High-Speed Rail Corridor, is under construction.

Objective: To strengthen regional connectivity and economic growth by reducing the Delhi–Siliguri journey time from approximately **20 hours to 6 hours.**

Make in India: The corridor is planned to be developed under the Make in India initiative, using domestically manufactured components and Indian engineering expertise.

Corridor Length & Route: The proposed high-speed rail corridor will connect Delhi to Guwahati via **Agra, Kanpur, Lucknow, Ayodhya, Varanasi, Prayagraj, Patna and Siliguri.**

States/UTs Covered: National Capital Territory **(NCT)** of Delhi, Uttar Pradesh (UP), Bihar, West Bengal (WB) and Assam.

Affordable Fares: Bullet train fares are expected to be lower than airfares, improving accessibility for middle-income groups.

Economic & Industrial Boost: Promote small-scale industries, employment and domestic manufacturing under the Make in India initiative, benefiting youth and local artisans.

About Ministry of Railways(MoR):

Union Minister- Ashwini Vaishnaw (Rajya Sabha- Odisha)

Minister of State **(MoS)-** Veeranna Somanna (Constituency- Tumkur, Karnataka)

India Hosts First-Ever BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise in Andaman and Nicobar Islands

In October 2026, **India's** Andaman and Nicobar Command **(ANC),** an integrated tri-services command of the Indian Armed Forces, is hosting the **first-ever** Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation **(BIMSTEC) Maritime Security Exercise** in Sri Vijaya Puram, **Andaman and Nicobar Islands**.

- The exercise, held from **30 October to 3 November 2026**, brought together all seven BIMSTEC member countries, **Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand,** to strengthen maritime cooperation and regional security in the Bay of Bengal.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** First-ever BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise.
- ✓ **Hosted By:** India' ANC & organized by Indian Navy.
- ✓ **Venue:** Sri Vijaya Puram, Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
- ✓ **When?** 30 October to 3 November 2026.
- ✓ **Participating Countries:** Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand.
- ✓ **Theme: Banner:** Shared Seas, Shared Security and Shared Prosperity, tagline – "Translating Vision to Action".
- ✓ **Phases:** Three-day Tabletop Exercise followed by a two-day Harbour Phase.
- ✓ **Announced At:** 6th BIMSTEC Summit, held in Thailand in April 2025.



Highlights of the BIMSTEC Maritime Security Exercise:

Background: The exercise was announced by Prime Minister **(PM)** Narendra Modi as a key initiative at the **6th BIMSTEC Summit**, held in Thailand in April 2025 under the theme "BIMSTEC: Prosperous, Resilient and Open (PRO)."

Objectives: Aims to enhance **operational coordination** and **interoperability**, strengthen maritime domain awareness, improve coordination mechanisms and facilitate the exchange of operational best practices.

Theme: The exercise is being conducted under the banner of "Shared Seas, Shared Security and Shared Prosperity" and the tagline "Translating Vision to Action".

Phases: The five-day exercise was organized by Indian Navy (IN) into **two phases**.

- **Tabletop:** The first phase involved **three days** of Tabletop Exercises, focusing on scenario-based discussions, planning and coordination among participating countries.
- **Harbour:** The second phase consists of a two-day Harbour Phase involving ships from BIMSTEC member countries, including **Sri Lanka Naval Ship (SLNS) Gajabahu** and Union of Myanmar Ship (**UMS) King Aung Zeya**, to strengthen operational coordination, mutual understanding and maritime interoperability.

Significance: The Bay of Bengal is vital for regional trade, connectivity and energy security, while ANC supports maritime surveillance, humanitarian assistance and disaster relief (HADR), search and rescue, and regional engagement.

About Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC);

Overview: BIMSTEC promotes regional cooperation through 7 priority areas: Trade, Investment and Development; Environment and Climate Change; Security; Agriculture and Food Security; People-to-People Contact; Science, Technology and Innovation; and Connectivity. Its chairmanship rotates alphabetically among member countries, with Bangladesh assuming the chairmanship in April 2025.

Establishment: BIMSTEC was established on 6 June 1997 in Bangkok, Thailand, as BIST-EC (Bangladesh, India, Sri Lanka and Thailand Economic Cooperation) and renamed BIMSTEC at its first Summit on 31 July 2004.

Significance: BIMSTEC supports India's Neighbourhood First and Act East policies by strengthening regional connectivity, maritime cooperation and economic development, particularly in India's northeastern states.

Secretary General – Ambassador Indra Mani Pandey (India)

Headquarters: Dhaka, Bangladesh (Permanent secretariat).

Union Minister Dr Mansukh Mandaviya Inaugurates 74th Foundation Day of EPFO in New Delhi

On 01 November 2026, **Union Minister Dr. Mansukh Mandaviya,** Ministry of Labour & Employment **(MoL&E)** inaugurated the **74th** Foundation Day celebrations of Employees' Provident Fund Organisation **(EPFO)** held at Dr. Ambedkar International Centre (AIC) in New Delhi (Delhi).

- During the event, he launched several key EPFO initiatives such as the Automatic Settlement of eligible inoperative EPF Accounts with balances up to Rs 1,000 and EPFO services via WhatsApp, among others.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 74th Foundation Day of EPFO
- ✓ **Date**: 1 November 2026
- ✓ **Inaugurated by:** Union Minister Dr Mansukh Mandaviya, MoL&E
- ✓ **Venue:** Dr. Ambedkar International Centre (New Delhi, Delhi)
- ✓ **Publications Released:** 7
- ✓ **Key Launches:** automatic settlement of eligible inoperative EPF Accounts with balances up to Rs 1,000; EPFO services via WhatsApp; and release of 7 key publications

Key Highlights:

Bhavishya Nidhi Awards 2026: During the event, EPFO presented Bhavishya Nidhi Awards 2026, honouring outstanding contributions by Regional Offices, Zonal Offices, individual officers and employees.

- Key Areas: The awards recognised excellence in regional and district-level performance; grievance management, pension services, death claim settlement and PRAYAAS (Prioritizing Pensioners), Pradhan Mantri Viksit Bharat Rozgar Yojana (PMVBRY), among others.

Key Initiatives Launched:

EPFO Services via WhatsApp: The new initiative will enable the EPF subscribers to access their Provident Fund (PF) balance, latest five transactions and passbook information through EPFO's verified WhatsApp service.

- In addition, the subscribers will receive personalised guidance and assistance in completing PMVBRY-related requirements.

Automatic Settlement of Inoperative EPF Accounts: The newly launched initiative will enable automatic processing and settlement of inoperative EPF accounts with balances up to Rs 1,000. It is expected to benefit nearly one lakh accounts involving Rs 5 crore.

Release of Key Publications: The event saw the release of seven publications which reflects EPFO's commitment to knowledge creation, institutional learning, legal awareness and compassionate governance:

- **EPFO State Profile 2026** (documents EPFO's geographical presence, state-wise coverage, membership, establishments, claims and pensioner statistics);
- **Compendium of Judgements 2026** (documents important judicial pronouncements on social security legislation);
- **Kendra Nidhi – Hindi Magazine 2026–27** (presents the literary and creative contributions of EPFO officers and employees and promotes Hindi);
- **Beyond the Desk, Beyond the Ordinary** (recognises the diverse talents and accomplishments of EPFO personnel);
- **Reimagining Governance: Discourse for Excellence (RGDE):** (presents insights from the dialogue series initiated by Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya National Academy of Social Security (PDUNASS) focused on ethical leadership, compassionate governance, among others);
- **Shasan Vidhi Mein Karuna (Compassion in Governance):** (presents 83 real-life case studies from 62 Regional Offices in resolving members' grievances);
- **The Indian Journal of Social Security – Volume 1, 2026** (compiles research contributions by EPFO officers on issues like: social security, labour markets, digital transformation and pension administration).

About Employees' Provident Fund Organisation (EPFO):

Central Provident Fund Commissioner **(CPFC)-** Ramesh Krishnamurthi
Headquarters- New Delhi, Delhi
Established- 1952

Manipur CM Yumnam Khemchand Launches BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week 2026 in Imphal

In November 2026, **Yumnam Khemchand Singh**, Chief Minister (CM) of Manipur, launched the **'BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week 2026(1–7 November)'** and flagged off a **cyclothon** at Khuman Lampak Sports Complex, Imphal, Manipur, to promote sustainable living and environmental responsibility.

- The week-long programme, organised by the Government of Manipur from **1 to 7 November 2026**, aims to encourage people to adopt environmentally friendly practices and protect natural resources.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Launch of BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week 2026
- ✓ **Launched By:** Yumnam Khemchand Singh, CM of Manipur
- ✓ **Organised By:** Government of Manipur
- ✓ **Duration:** 1–7 November 2026

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- ✓ **Venue:** Khuman Lampak Sports Complex, Imphal
- ✓ **Associated Event:** Imphal Cyclothon
- ✓ **Inspiration:** Mission LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment).

About BRICS Sustainable Lifestyle Week 2026:

Objective: The weeklong campaign to encourage citizens to adopt sustainable, environmentally responsible habits through simple changes in daily activities.

Inspiration: The initiative draws inspiration from **Mission LiFE** (Lifestyle for Environment), launched by Prime Minister (PM) **Narendra Modi in 2022** to promote sustainable lifestyles and environmental conservation.

Cyclothon: Around 200 cyclists participated in the event, starting and concluding at Khuman Lampak Sports Complex, via Khuyathong Road, Babupara and parts of Imphal West and Imphal East.

Environmental Pledge: CM Yumnam Khemchand Sin administered a pledge to protect the environment and joined other dignitaries in planting Uningthou saplings at the sports complex.

Assam Government Signs Rs 600 Crore MoU with Belgium's IBA to Set Up Proton Beam Therapy Centre in Guwahati

In October 2026, the **Government of Assam** signed a Memorandum of Understanding (**MoU**) with **Belgium-**based Ion Beam Applications (**IBA**) to establish a Proton Beam Therapy Centre at Gauhati Medical College and Hospital **(GMCH)** in Guwahati, Assam, at an estimated cost of Rs 600 crore.

- The proposed Guwahati facility will become **India's third** Proton Beam Therapy Centre and the first to be established in the public health sector.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** MoU signed
- ✓ **Entities:** Government of Assam and IBA Particles, Belgium
- ✓ **Estimated Cost:** Rs. 600 crore.
- ✓ **Purpose:** Establish India's first public Proton Beam Therapy Centre at GMCH
- ✓ **Funding:** Rs. 315 crore WB loan and Rs. 285 crore from the Assam Government.
- ✓ **Project:** ASSIST
- ✓ **Implementing Organisation:** AHIDMS.

About Public Proton Beam Therapy Centre:

Approval: In August 2026, the Assam State Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister (CM) Himanta Biswa Sarma, approved the project under the Assam State Secondary Healthcare Initiative for Service Delivery Transformation **(ASSIST).**

Funding: The PBT project has an estimated cost of **Rs. 600 crore**, jointly funded through a World Bank loan of **Rs. 315 crore** and a **Rs. 285 crore** contribution from the Government of Assam.

Implementation: The project will be implemented through the Assam Health Infrastructure Development & Management Society (**AHIDMS**), with the facility expected to become operational within at least three years.

Technology: The facility will feature the **ProteusONE system**, a compact proton therapy system developed by IBA for precise radiation treatment.

BANKING & FINANCE

SEBI Extends KYC Review Periodicity to 8 Years for Eligible Foreign Portfolio Investors

In October 2026, the Securities and Exchange Board of India (**SEBI**) released the circular "**Rationalisation of periodicity of KYC review for FPIs**", extending the Know Your Customer **(KYC) review periodicity** for

eligible Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) from **3 years to 8 years,** to simplify regulatory compliance and improve ease of doing business.

- Under the revised framework, SEBI also extended the annual KYC review period from 1 year to **2 years** for specified FPIs, with the new provisions taking effect from **1 December 2026.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** SEBI released circular on KYC review for FPIs
- ✓ **Existing framework:** FPI review – every one or three years
- ✓ **Effective Date:** December 1, 2026
- ✓ **Objective**: To reduce repetitive compliance requirements and improve ease of doing business for FPIs
- ✓ **Revised KYC Periodicity**: 1 year to 2 years; 3 years to 8 years
- ✓ **8-Year Eligibility:** Specified Category I FPIs and regulated Category II FPIs
- ✓ **SWAGAT-FI FPIs:** Existing 10-year KYC cycle retained.

Existing Framework:

Categories of FPI: The FPIs are broadly classified into:

- **Category I:** This includes investors such as government-related entities, appropriately regulated funds and certain institutional investors that are considered to have a relatively lower risk profile.
- **Category II:** This category covers a wider range of investors, including appropriately regulated entities and other eligible funds and institutions that do not qualify for Category I.

Existing Framework: Under the existing framework, FPIs were required to undergo periodic KYC (Know Your Customer) reviews every **one or three years**, depending on their jurisdiction, category and regulatory status.

Category I FPI: In the existing framework, **Category I FPIs** from non-high-risk jurisdictions will undergo KYC reviews once every **eight years.**

Change Intimation Requirement: Apart from the KYC review, SEBI has removed the requirement for FPIs to intimate changes in previously submitted information or provide a declaration confirming that no changes have occurred at the time of continuing their registration.

Fees Payment: The regulator has specified that FPIs must pay the continuance fee at least **15 days** before the expiry of their current registration validity to facilitate a smooth continuance process.

New Framework:

Category I FPI: The new KYC review periodicity for Category I FPIs:

- **High-Risk Jurisdictions:** Category I FPIs registered under Regulation 5(a)(i) will undergo KYC reviews once every eight years.
- **Other Category I FPIs from High-Risk Jurisdictions:** KYC reviews will be conducted once every two years.
- **Non-High-Risk Jurisdictions:** All Category I FPIs will undergo KYC reviews once every eight years.

Category II FPI: The new KYC review periodicity for Category II FPIs:

- **High-Risk Jurisdictions:** All Category II FPIs will undergo KYC reviews once every two years.
- **Non-High-Risk Jurisdictions – Regulated Entities:** Regulated Category II FPIs will undergo KYC reviews once every eight years.
- **Non-High-Risk Jurisdictions – Other Entities:** Other Category II FPIs will continue to undergo KYC reviews once every two years.

Special Category: SEBI has retained the existing KYC review requirements for the following categories:

- **Government Securities – FPIs (GS-FPIs):** The review periodicity for these securities will remain linked to the KYC review requirements to their respective bank accounts under the Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) guidelines.
- **SWAGAT-FI (Single Window Automatic and Generalised Access for Trusted Foreign Investors) FPIs:** The existing 10 year KYC review cycle will continue.

Fee Payment: Under the revised provisions, FPIs seeking to continue their registration for another three-year period, or 10 years in the case of SWAGAT-FI, will be required to pay the applicable fees to their Designated Depository Participants (**DDPs**).

Note: Regulation 5(a)(i) of the SEBI (Foreign Portfolio Investors) Regulations, 2019 deals with Government and Government-related investors that are eligible for registration as Category I Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs).

About Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI):

The SEBI, a market regulator, was constituted as a non-statutory body on April 12,1988 through a resolution of the Government of India (GoI) and was established as a statutory body in 1992.

Chairman – Tuhin Kanta Pandey

Headquarters – Mumbai, Maharashtra

AWARDS & RECOGNITIONS

MHA Minister Amit Shah Presents President's Colour to Chandigarh Police on 60th Raising Day

In November 2026, Union Minister **Amit Shah**, Ministry of Home Affairs **(MHA)** presented the prestigious President's Colour to Chandigarh Police during its **60th Raising Day** and Diamond Jubilee celebrations at the Police Lines in Chandigarh, recognising the **force's six decades of service**, dedication and contribution to maintaining law and order and tackling terrorism.

Exam hints:

- ✓ **What?** President's Colour presented to Chandigarh Police.
- ✓ **Presented By** – Union Home Minister Amit Shah.
- ✓ **Occasion** – 60th Raising Day and Diamond Jubilee celebrations.
- ✓ **Venue –** Police Lines, Sector 26, Chandigarh.
- ✓ **New Vehicles –** 141 vehicles flagged off for Chandigarh Police.
- ✓ **AI Surveillance** – 2,152 additional AI-enabled cameras provided by the Centre.

Others:

- ✓ **What?** 'Run for Unity' flagged off.
- ✓ **Flagged Off By** – Union Home Minister Amit Shah.
- ✓ **Occasion –** 151st birth anniversary of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel.
- ✓ **Target Date** – 31 December 2029.

Highlights of the 60th Raising Day Celebrations:

Personnel: Chandigarh Police comprises more than **6,000 personnel** across various wings, including the Crime Wing, Operations Cell, Security Wing, Traffic Police and Police Control Room (PCR).

Technology: The Centre provided 2,152 additional Artificial Intelligence (AI)-enabled surveillance cameras, supplementing around 2,130 existing cameras. He also flagged off **141 new vehicles** to strengthen patrolling, mobility and emergency response.

Performance: Since 4 August 2024, the force registered 8,206 First Information Reports, filed online chargesheets in 7,590 cases (92.5%) and achieved conviction rates of 85% overall and 93% under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances Act.

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- Its average response time was **4 minutes**, with Quick Response (QR) Teams reaching incident sites in about **10 minutes**.

Achievements: Chandigarh Police won **145 medals** at the All India Police Duty Meet, comprising **35 gold,** 38 silver and 72 bronze medals.

Others: Union Minister Amit Shah (MHA) flagged off the **'Run for Unity'** in New Delhi, Delhi to mark the **151st birth anniversary** of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel and set 31 December 2029 as the target to make India completely drug-free.

APPOINTMENTS & RESIGNATIONS

Former VP Iliana Iotova Became Bulgaria's 1st Elected Female President

In November 2026, Former Vice President (VP) and the Acting President of **Bulgaria Iliana Iotova** won the presidential runoff election held on 1 November 2026, becoming the country's **first democratically elected female President.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Bulgaria's 1st Elected Female President
- ✓ **Who?** Iliana Iotova (secured 57.58% votes)
- ✓ **Defeated:** Andrey Gyurov (39.47%)
- ✓ **Predecessor:** Rumen Radev.

Election Results:

Votes Secured: Iliana Iotova and her Vice-Presidential candidate Kiril Valchev secured **57.58%** of votes (approximately 1.1 million ballots) in Bulgaria's presidential runoff election.

Opponent: She defeated former caretaker Prime Minister (PM) **Andrey Gyurov** and his Vice-Presidential candidate **Georgi Kandev**, who secured **39.47%** of votes (approximately 7.5 lakh ballots).

About Iliana Iotova:

Early Career: Worked as a journalist at Bulgarian National Television (1990–1997) and served as a Member of Bulgaria's National Assembly from 2005 to 2007.

Political Career: During her initial political career, Iliana served as a Member of the Bulgarian National Assembly and headed the press official of the Bulgarian Socialist Party (BSP)

European Parliament Member: Previously, she served as member at the European Parliament for 10 years (from 2007 to 2017).

Vice President: Prior to her appointment as the Acting head of the state, she served as the Vice President (VP) of Bulgaria from 2017 to 2026.

Acting Head of State: In January 2026, she was officially appointed as the Acting Head of the state after her longtime ally, president Rumen Radev resigned to contest parliamentary election.

About Bulgaria:

Capital- Sofia

Currency- Euro (EUR)

Dinesh Vitthalrao Ganvir Assumes Charge as 55th DG of GSI

In November 2026, renowned geologist **Dinesh Vitthalrao Ganvir** officially assumed the charge as the **55th** Director General **(DG)** of the Geological Survey of India **(GSI),** under the Ministry of Mines (MoM), succeeding **Varsha Ashok Agalwe** (54th and 1st woman DG of GSI), who retired from service upon superannuation.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 55th DG of GSI Officially Assumes Charge

- ✓ **Who?** Dinesh Vitthalrao Ganvir
- ✓ **Previous Role:** ADG and HoD of GSI's Central Region, Nagpur, and National Mission Head-II.
- ✓ **Predecessor:** Varsha Ashok Agalwe

About Dinesh Ganvir:

Experience: Ganvir brings over 32 years of scientific, technical and administrative experience, spanning geological investigations, mineral exploration and engineering geology, with assignments across GSI's Central, North-Eastern and Northern Regions.

Previous Role: Prior to his appointment as DG of GSI, Ganvir served as the Additional Director General (ADG) and Head of Department (HoD), Central Region, Nagpur, Maharashtra (GSI), while also holding the additional charge of National Mission Head-II.

Key Contributions: During his long illustrious career with GSI, he contributed significantly to geological mapping, gold and diamond exploration and studies related to the conservation of United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organisation (UNESCO) World Heritage Sites (WHS), including Bhimbetka Rock shelters and Ellora Caves.

- As National Mission Head-II, he strengthened critical and strategic mineral exploration, contributing to a 5-fold increase in investigations.
- Key outputs included 359 geological reports, 377 geological memorandums, and identification of 202 critical mineral blocks, of which 40 were auctioned.

Global Representation: He has represented GSI at various global forums, such as: India–Peru Joint Working Group (JWG), the Russia–India Mining Sub-Group and International Mining and Resources Conference (IMARC) 2022 in Australia.

About Geological Survey of India (GSI):

Origin- The term "GSI" was 1st used by John McClelland in his report in 1848 and he designated himself as officiating Surveyor, Geological Survey till April 1850.

Establishment- GSI, one of the world's oldest survey organisations, was established in 1851with primary purpose to locate coal deposits for the Railways.

Headquarters- Kolkata, West Bengal (WB)

6 Regional Offices: GSI has six regional offices: Eastern Region in Kolkata (West Bengal, WB), Western Region in Jaipur (Rajasthan), Northern Region in Lucknow (Uttar Pradesh, UP), Southern Region in Hyderabad (Telangana), Central Region in Nagpur (Maharashtra), and North-Eastern Region in Shillong (Meghalaya).

Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal Takes Over as AOC-in-C of IAF's Eastern Air Command

On 1 November 2026, **Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal,** assumed charge as the Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief **(AOC-in-C)** of the Eastern Air Command **(EAC)**, Indian Air Force **(IAF)**.

- He succeeded **Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia**, who was appointed as the Vice Chief of the Air Staff (VCAS).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Appointment of Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief
- ✓ **Who?** Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal
- ✓ **Predecessor:** Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia
- ✓ **Previous Position:** Senior Air Staff Officer, South Western Air Command
- ✓ **Awards:** Ati Vishisht Seva Medal and Vayu Sena Medal.

About Air Marshal Mehtab Singh Deswal:

Career Profile: He was commissioned into the IAF Flying Branch as a fighter pilot in June 1989 and has over 3,200 flying hours, specialising in strike aircraft and air defence operations.

- He was also part of the core team involved in the induction of the **Su-30K** into the IAF in 1997.

Key Roles: Served as Commanding Officer of a fighter squadron, Air Officer Commanding (AOC) of two flying bases, Air Attaché at the Embassy of India in Pakistan and Director General (Weapon Systems) at Air Headquarters.

- Before assuming the new role, he served as Senior Air Staff Officer (SASO) at Headquarters South Western Air Command (SWAC).

Awards and Honours: In recognition of his distinguished service, he was awarded the Ati Vishisht Seva Medal **(AVSM)** and Vayu Sena Medal **(VM).**

About EAC: One of the five operational commands of the IAF, EAC is headquartered in Upper Shillong, Meghalaya. Initially established in1958 and it was upgraded to a full command on 1 December 1959.

SPORTS

India Wins Both Men's and Women's Titles at Inaugural Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026 in Ahmedabad, Gujarat

India emerged as the champion in both **men's and women's categories** at the **inaugural Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026, held from 23 to 31 October 2026** at Veer Savarkar Sports Complex in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.

- The Indian men's team secured gold by defeating **Sri Lanka** 54–20, while the Indian women's team clinched gold with a 35–15 victory over **Uganda** in their respective finals.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Inaugural Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026
- ✓ **Where?** Ahmedabad, Gujarat
- ✓ **Organisers:** AKFI & IKF
- ✓ **Men's Final Winner:** India defeated Sri Lanka 54–20
- ✓ **Women's Final Winner:** India defeated Uganda 35–15.

About Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026:

Organiser: The event was organised by the Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India **(AKFI)** with approval from the International Kabaddi Federation **(IKF).**

Theme: "One Breath. One Raid. One Commonwealth."

Significance: Served as a major global platform to showcase kabaddi and build momentum for its future inclusion in the main Commonwealth Games programme.

Participation: The championship featured 13 Commonwealth nations, with 23 teams (13 men's and 10 women's) and more than 400 athletes, competing in 62 matches.

Tournament Format: Featured a single round-robin group stage, with top-performing teams advancing to knockout semi-finals and finals.

Team Divisions: The men's division featured 13 teams across two groups – Group A: India, Nigeria, Malaysia, Uganda, England, Tanzania and Sri Lanka; Group B: Bangladesh, Kenya, Canada, Australia, Scotland and Singapore.

- The women's division featured 10 teams across two groups – Group A: India, Nigeria, Singapore, Uganda and Malaysia; Group B: Bangladesh, Kenya, England, Sri Lanka and Scotland.

Highlights:

Men's Final:

- **Raiders:** Aditya Shinde (India) scored 10 raid points (Super 10), Bharat Hooda (India) eight and Pankaj Mohite (India) six, while Naveen Kumar (India) added five points.

- **Defence:** Yogesh Dahiya (India) registered a High 5 (5/5 tackles), while Shubham Shinde (India), Surjeet Singh (India), Pravesh Malik (India) and Deepak Sankar (India) scored two tackle points each.

Men's Campaign: India topped Group A with six wins, defeated Bangladesh 56–27 in the semi-final and Sri Lanka 54–20 in the final, completing an unbeaten campaign with 380 points scored and 193 conceded across eight matches.

Women's Final:

- **Performance:** India defeated Uganda 35–15, leading 22–7 at half-time; Sakshi (India) scored nine raid points, Anu Sen (India) six and captain Nidhi Sharma (India) five, while Ritu Mitharwal (India) and Suman Sahu (India) contributed four tackle points each.
- **Statistics:** India scored 20 raid points, 10 tackle points and inflicted two all-outs, while Nakayongo Shirat (Uganda) scored 11 points.

Women's Campaign: India topped Group A with victories over Malaysia (73–13), Singapore (32–16), Uganda (41–18) and Nigeria (38–10), before defeating Sri Lanka 39–14 in the semi-final and Uganda 35–15 in the final.

- Sakshi (India) scored 52 points across six matches, emerging as one of India's leading performers.

Medal Tally at Commonwealth Kabaddi Championship 2026:

Event	Gold	Silver	Bronze
Men's	India	Sri Lanka	Kenya
			Bangladesh
Women's	India	Uganda	Kenya
			Sri Lanka

About International Kabaddi Federation (IKF):

IKF is an international governing body of the sport of kabaddi.
President – Vinod Kumar Tiwari
Headquarters – Jaipur, Rajasthan
Established – 2004 (formally registered in India in December 2006).

Senior World Wrestling Championships 2026: USA Tops; India Won 4 Medals; Manisha Bhanwala Won India's First Gold in Women's Freestyle

The **Senior World Wrestling Championships 2026** were held from **24** October to **1** November 2026 at Barys Arena, Astana, **Kazakhstan**, under the aegis of United World Wrestling **(UWW)**, where India concluded its campaign with **four medals** (1 gold, 2 silver and 1 bronze), all won by the women's freestyle squad.

- **Manisha Bhanwala** became the **first** Indian woman to win gold at the Senior World Wrestling Championships and the second Indian wrestler overall, after Sushil Kumar (men's 66 kilogram (kg), 2010), to claim a world title.
- United States of America **(USA)** topped the medal tally with 15 medals (7 Gold, 2 Silver and 6 Bronze), followed by **Iran** with 15 medals (6 Gold, 4 Silver and 5 Bronze), and **Russia** with 14 medals (4 Gold, 3 Silver and 7 Bronze).

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Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** World Wrestling Championships 2026
- ✓ **When?** 24 October – 1 November 2026
- ✓ **Where?** Barys Arena, Astana, Kazakhstan
- ✓ **Organiser:** UWW
- ✓ **Host:** Kazakhstan
- ✓ **Top 3:** USA (15 medals 7G, 2S, 6B); Iran (15 medals (6 Gold, 4 Silver and 5 Bronze), Russia (14 medals 4G, 3S, 7B).
- ✓ **Team Champions:** Men & Women Freestyle – USA (194 points); Men's Greco-Roman- Iran (192 points)
- ✓ **India's Tally:** 1 gold, 2 silver, 1 bronze (all in women's wrestling)
- ✓ **India's Medal:** (In Women's Freestyle)
  - **Gold –** Manisha Bhanwala (Women's 59kg), India's First Gold in Women's Freestyle
  - **Silver** – Neelam Sirohi (Women's 50kg) and Kajal Dhochak (Women's 76kg)
  - **Bronze** – Tanu Sharma (Women's 72kg)

About World Wrestling Championships 2026:

Overview: The 2026 edition featured nearly 900 wrestlers from 90 countries, competing for **30 world titles** across **three** disciplines: men's freestyle, men's Greco-Roman and women's wrestling, with 10 weight categories in each discipline.

- Each weight category awards four medals: one gold, one silver and two bronze.

Team Rankings: USA topped **men's freestyle** with 194 points and **women's freestyle** with 137 points, while **Iran** led **men's Greco-Roman wrestling** with 192 points.

Top 5 Medal Tally:

Rank	Nation	Gold	Silver	Bronze	Total
1	United States of America (USA)	7	2	6	15
2	Iran	6	4	5	15
3	Russia	4	3	7	14
4	Japan	3	3	4	10
5	China	3	0	3	6
6	**India**	**1**	**2**	**1**	**4**

India Medal Tally:

Athlete	Event	Category	Medal
Manisha Bhanwala	Women's Freestyle	59kg	Gold
Neelam Sirohi	Women's Freestyle	50kg	Silver
Kajal Dhochak	Women's Freestyle	76kg	Silver
Tanu Sharma	Women's Freestyle	72kg	Bronze

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India's Medal Winners:

Women's Freestyle 59kg: 2025 Asian champion **Manisha Bhanwala** became India's first female world champion in wrestling after trailing 0–6 against Abigail Nette, USA, in the final.

Women's Freestyle 50kg: Neelam Sirohi secured the silver medal after losing to Japan's Yui Susaki, a four-time World Champion and Tokyo Olympic gold medallist, in the final.

Women's Freestyle 76kg: At 18, two-time Under-20 World Champion **Kajal Dhochak** won silver in the women's 76 kg category after losing 6–8 to two-time European Champion Anastasiya Alpyeyeva of Ukraine, becoming the first Indian woman heavyweight medallist at the Senior World Wrestling Championships.

Women's Freestyle 72kg: Tanu Sharma clinched the bronze medal.

Milestone: India's **Lalit Sehrawat** reached the bronze-medal bout in the Men's Greco-Roman 55 kg (Kilogram) category, becoming the first Indian in 13 years to contest a medal round in Greco-Roman wrestling at the World Championships.

About United World Wrestling (UWW):

Establishment: Founded in 1912 as the International Federation of Associated Wrestling Styles (FILA), it was renamed UWW in September 2014 and serves as the international governing body for amateur wrestling, overseeing the sport at the Olympic Games and World Wrestling Championships.

President – Nenad Lalovic

Headquarters – Corsier-sur-Vevey, Switzerland

Rahul Dravid and Saina Nehwal Nominated to 2030 Commonwealth Games Organising Committee

In October 2026, former Indian cricket captain **Rahul Dravid** and Olympic medallist **Saina Nehwal** were nominated by the Union Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports **(MYAS)** as athlete representatives to the proposed Organising Committee (OC) for the 2030 Commonwealth Games **(CWG)**, scheduled to be held in Ahmedabad, Gujarat.

- **Jinal Mehta** and **Ananya Birla** were recommended as private-sector representatives to the 2030 CWG Organising Committee.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Nominations to 2030 CWG Organising Committee
- ✓ **Nominated By:** Ministry of Youth Affairs and Sports (MYAS)
- ✓ **Athlete Representatives:** Rahul Dravid and Saina Nehwal
- ✓ **Private-Sector Nominees:** Jinal Mehta and Ananya Birla
- ✓ **Host City:** Ahmedabad, Gujarat.
- ✓ **Committee Strength:** 12–15 members.

Highlights of the 2030 Commonwealth Games Organising Committee:

Leadership: Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister (CM) Harsh Sanghavi is expected to head the Organising Committee. Union Sports Secretary Hari Ranjan Rao and Indian Olympic Association (IOA) President P. T. Usha is expected to serve as Vice-Chairpersons, while Gujarat government Principal Secretary M. Thennarasan has been appointed Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

Composition: The Organising Committee is expected to comprise **12–15 members**, including representatives from the Indian Olympic Association (IOA) and Commonwealth Sport, the governing body of the Games. Lieutenant General **Harpal Singh** will represent the Commonwealth Games Association of India.

Games Plan: India plans to include 15–17 sporting disciplines in the 2030 Games, compared with 10 disciplines at the 2026 Glasgow Commonwealth Games. The proposed programme aims to include popular sports such as hockey, wrestling and cricket.

About CWG: Established in 1930, with its first edition held in Hamilton, Canada; its headquarters is in London, United Kingdom, its President is Dr. Donald Rukare, and the 2030 edition is scheduled to be held in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, India.

OBITUARY

Veteran Dogri Writer and Filmmaker Ved Rahi Passes Away at 93

In November 2026, veteran Dogri writer, screenwriter and filmmaker **Ved Rahi** passed away at the age of 93 in Thane, Maharashtra. He was born on 22 May 1933 in Jammu, Jammu and Kashmir (J&K).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Veteran Dogri writer and filmmaker passed away
- ✓ **Who?** Ved Rahi
- ✓ **Where?** Thane, Maharashtra
- ✓ **Literary Award**: Sahitya Akademi Award in 1983 for 'Dogri'
- ✓ **Fellowship**: Sahitya Akademi Fellowship (Mahattar Sadasyata).

About Ved Rahi:

Profile: He was the son of Lala Mulk Raj Saraf, who established the **first newspaper** in the princely state of J&K in 1924.

Early Career: He began his literary journey as a **Dogri writer** in Jammu before moving to Mumbai to explore opportunities in the Hindi film industry.

Contribution: Ved Rahi contributed to Dogri literature through stories, novels and poetry, receiving honours such as the Maharashtra Gaurav Award, Rahul Sankrityayan Award and Kusumagraj Rashtriya Sahitya Puraskar.

- He wrote scripts and dialogues for around 25 Hindi films, including Yeh Raat Phir Na Aayegi and Bezubaan, directed Prem Parbat, Kali Ghata and Veer Savarkar (2001), and directed Doordarshan serials such as Gul Gulshan Gulfam (45 episodes), Meera and Rishtay.

Awards: He received the **Sahitya Akademi Award in 1983** for his Dogri short-story collection Aale and the **Sahitya Akademi Fellowship in 2024** (Mahattar Sadasyata).

IMPORTANT DAYS

International Day to End Impunity for Crimes against Journalists 2026 – November 2

The United Nations (UN's) **International Day to End Impunity for Crimes against Journalists** (IDEI) is observed globally every year on **2 November** to highlight violence against journalists, combat impunity and promote accountability, press freedom and freedom of expression.

- The **IDEI** marks its 13th annual observance in 2026.

Theme:

2026 Theme: "Threats Evolve. Impunity Endures."

Focus: Addressing emerging threats to journalists from new technologies and weapons, particularly drones in conflict zones, and strengthening accountability mechanisms to combat impunity.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** International Day to End Impunity for Crimes against Journalists 2026
- ✓ **When?** 2 November 2026
- ✓ **2026 Theme:** "Threats Evolve. Impunity Endures."

- ✓ **Purpose:** To end impunity for crimes against journalists, ensure accountability and protect press freedom
- ✓ **First Observed:** 2 November 2014
- ✓ **Global Commemoration Venue (2026):** UNESCO Headquarters, Paris, France
- ✓ **2026 Report:** UNESCO Director-General's Report on the Safety of Journalists and the Danger of Impunity (2024–2025).

Background:

Initiative: In 2012, the UN launched the UN Plan of Action on the Safety of Journalists and the Issue of Impunity, establishing a coordinated global framework for journalist safety and accountability.

UN Recognition: The assassination of French journalists Ghislaine Dupont and Claude Verlon in Kidal, Mali, on 2 November 2013, inspired the observance.

- Subsequently, the UN General Assembly (UNGA) adopted Resolution A/RES/68/163 on 18 December 2013, proclaiming 2 November as the International Day.

First Observance: The IDEI was first observed globally on **2 November 2014.**

2026 Report:

Overview: First published in 2008, the report is issued biennially (every two years) and submitted to the Intergovernmental Council of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC).

Key Findings: The 2026 Director-General's Report on the Safety of Journalists and the Danger of Impunity, covering 2024–2025, was released on the occasion of IDEI 2026.

- **189** journalists killed during 2024–2025; 67% in conflict zones; 50 killed by drones across six war zones; global impunity rate reached 86%, leaving nearly 9 out of 10 cases unresolved.

2026 Event:

Global Commemoration: Held on 2 November 2026 at United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization **(UNESCO)** Headquarters, Paris, France, to combat impunity, strengthen accountability and protect journalists.

Policy Dialogue & Townhall: Brought together Member States and other stakeholders to strengthen the UN Plan of Action on the Safety of Journalists and the Issue of Impunity, focusing on accountability and journalist protection.

About United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization (UNESCO):

Director-General (**DG**) – Khaled El-Enany (Egypt)

Established – 1945

Headquarters – Paris, France.

STATE NEWS

Digital Bharat Nidhi Signs Agreement with TN to Expand BharatNet Connectivity under ABP

In October 2026, Digital Bharat Nidhi **(DBN)**, under the Department of Telecommunications **(DoT)**, Ministry of Communications, signed a **Utilisation Agreement** with the Government of Tamil Nadu(TN) and TN FibreNet Corporation **(TANFINET)** at Sanchar Bhawan, New Delhi, to strengthen rural broadband connectivity in TN under the Amended BharatNet Program (ABP).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Utilisation Agreement signed
- ✓ **Who?** DBN, Government of Tamil Nadu and TANFINET
- ✓ **Objective:** Expand rural broadband connectivity in TN
- ✓ **Implementation Model:** State-led model.

Key Highlights:

Objective: Strengthen rural broadband access and enable digital services such as electronic(e)-Governance, digital payments, online education and telemedicine.

Implementation Model: State-led model with financial subsidy support from the Government of India.

Connectivity: The agreement aims to facilitate more than 5 lakh rural household fibre connections and provide broadband access to 4,767 villages on a demand basis.

About DBN: Established as Universal Service Obligation Fund (USOF) in 2002 and renamed Digital Bharat Nidhi (DBN) under the Telecommunications Act, 2023, it supports BharatNet, 4G Saturation and rural mobile connectivity. The Union Cabinet approved the Amended BharatNet Program (ABP) on 4 August 2023.



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- HCLTech opens Bengaluru and Hubballi development centres for Rapidus semiconductor requirements
- Educator Tariq Marghoob Releases Born Whole, a Book on Rediscovering the Inner Intelligence We Were Taught to Doubt
- Union Education Minister Shri Pralhad Joshi Inaugurates CBSE Experience Centre in New Delhi
- Indian Culinary Institute Signs MoU with Jawaharlal Nehru University for Recognition of BBA and MBA Programmes

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Aspirant: Why is there a delayal in news?

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